be a bit of a consolation that the game was won by your boy.'

She was right. AB was my boy, not because I played any significant part in developing his talent but because, ever since he had made his debut for the Proteas in 2004, his approach to the game – his positive batting and his energetic presence in the field – resembled the way I played during my international career, which ended the year before, in 2003.

At times, it felt as if AB had seized the torch from me and was taking it to an altogether higher and unimagined level.

His complete destruction of the West Indian attack in Sydney during the 2015 World Cup was so ruthless, so complete and so breathtaking that it left me feeling genuinely sorry for the bowlers.

It was incredible to watch. He was clearly loving the game, mastering the game and yet humbly respecting it at the same time.

AB's career achievements so far have honoured cricket wherever the game is played and Ricky Ponting was 100% correct – he's a genius. I am honoured that AB asked me to write this Foreword to his autobiography and I always feel privileged to be associated with him in any way.

Jonty Rhodes
March 2016

JONTY RHODES played 52 Tests and 245 one-day internationals for South Africa between 1992 and 2003, scoring more than 8 000 runs. Through his infectious energy and brilliant fielding, he became the most recognisable face in the Proteas team that emerged from isolation. He now works in the media and as a coach.